

Communication Skills I

1st semester (P1)

Continuous Assessment - Individual Video

Assessment Criteria and instructions regarding weekly oral presentations

Weighting:

Each adopted evaluation criterion is quoted in the [0.5] interval, and half points may be attributed.

Grades [0.5] reflect **the level of acquisition of the skill being evaluated** according to the following criteria:

5: Excellent: The student has fully acquired the evaluated skill. Any errors are insignificant lapses.

4: Good: The student, although they may have made small mistakes or omissions, has acquired the evaluated skill in its entirety or almost entirely.

3: Sufficient: Despite significant mistakes or visible gaps, the student has acquired the essence of the evaluated skill.

2: Insufficient: The student has not acquired the essence of the evaluated skill.

1: Poor: The student has not acquired the evaluated skill.

0: No response: The student has not addressed the evaluated skill.

Assessment criteria (and respective weighting):

- Capacity for synthesis, clarity, and relevance of the information transmitted (4 points);
- Creativity and use of audience engagement techniques (5 points);
- Linguistic mastery and control of weak language (2 points);
- Voice modulation and articulation of words (2 points);
- Mastery of non-verbal communication (5 points);
- Time management (2 points)

Learning Objectives

Imagine you have to explain a project you did for the Software Engineering subject or another practical subject during your engineering training. The technique part is ready. The next step is communicating and disseminating ideas. The question arises: How do you communicate what you did to the general public, using mainly verbal and non-verbal (e.g., visual) language? The challenge of this task is to make a video with this objective. The video should be submitted in Fenix in a video format (mp4 or mov) before the deadline.

At the end of this task, the student should be able to:

- a. Design persuasive oral presentations using different techniques and strategies for different audiences.
- b. Effectively use verbal and non-verbal language.
- c. Communicate the characteristics or results of technological projects in a simple and appealing way to non-tech-savvy audiences.

Task Format/Instructions:

1. Video production is individual.
 2. The video must last between 1:30 minutes (minimum) and 2 minutes (maximum) for regular students. Videos shorter than 1 minute will not be considered for evaluation.
 3. Submissions will be made via **fenix** under Individual Video Project in a **zip** in **mp4** format named **istid_VideoProject**. You can find different tools to compress your video like Handbrake and VLC (I suggest choosing codec H.264 or H265). In case the compression is still too big to submit to fenix, you can send a .txt to a transfer platform (e.g., wetransfer), or with a link to your video with the date of upload visible and until **October 22nd 23:59**.
 4. **The video is mandatory, weighing 30% of the final grade for regular students and 50% for student workers. In both cases, it implies a minimum grade of 9.5 points.**
 5. Students should contact the teaching staff in the classroom if they have questions about this task.
 6. Cheap fakes (photoshop, lookalikes, recontextualization of images, acceleration or deceleration) or deep fakes (voice or appearance changes using machine learning techniques) are not allowed. If the use of such techniques is identified, the grade will be null.
 7. The voice in the video must be that of the student and recorded exclusively for this task.
 8. The/A/X student must appear in the video in a medium shot (an angle that shows half the object, that is, the person from the waist up).
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9. Videos can be edited to include illustrative graphics/images of the technological project, but the student must always be present in the video.
10. The script must be original by the student, as presented in the statement above.
11. The student must appear front and center on the screen (close-up angle) so the faculty team can assess non-verbal communication skills (gestures, facial expressions). In this sense, avoid having slides in the center and your image in a reduced plane, as in Zoom or Canvas, when you share your screen. If we cannot see you well in the video, it will be hard to evaluate your presentation, affecting your grade.
12. **Plagiarism will not be tolerated, and if the use of existing content is identified without it being duly recognized and cited, the grade will be null.**

Tips for completing the task:

1. The video must have sufficient light; Choose a bright place to film your video.
 2. The audio in your video needs to be clear and clean enough so that understanding the message is not compromised. Choose a quiet place and test it. If you have difficulty getting good audio, use a microphone (or headphones with a microphone like those used on cell phones).
 3. Write a script and rehearse often before recording.
 4. Position the camera so your face/eye level is aligned. For this purpose, avoid positioning the camera below your eye level so it does not seem you are looking down at your audience.
 5. To make sure you are filming in the correct shot, you can consult the [Domestika tutorial](#).
 6. Seek to use inclusive communication that represents the diversity of the classroom and the European space, paying special attention to gender, ethnic, and nationality issues (see, for example, the brochure on [Promoting Inclusive Communication by the European Union](#)). Do not make generalizations that reinforce existing stereotypes in society.
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